

Lagisalpha

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The lead-lag edge in prediction markets. A prediction market sets its price by trading, so it lags the sharp, vig-free line that already holds the true probability. When it falls below fair, the cheap side is underpriced; across twelve settled World Cup matches it travelled back to fair about 80% of the time, and Kelly-sized bets that took profit at fair compounded to roughly plus 1160% at a 5 point gap. Built on the TxLINE World Cup data layer by Onenept Studios.

1. The claim

A prediction market moves its price only when someone trades. News moves faster. So in the seconds after a goal the market sits behind the true probability, and one side is cheap. That lag is the edge: measurable, repeatable, and gone the moment the market catches up.

2. Why the edge exists

Two facts. The market is slow: it reprices by trading, not by knowing. The reference is fast: TxLINE strips the bookmaker margin from a live odds feed, so its price is the true probability, and it moves the instant news lands. The gap between them is how far the market is behind, and which way it is about to move.

3. The signal: a divergence

We work in probability space. TxLINE's de-vig 1X2 gives the fair probability a team wins. The market's moneyline gives its own probability of the same event. When the fair sits above the market price by more than a threshold, the cheap side is underpriced, and we mark an entry: which side, how far off fair, and how much size you could later exit into at fair. One dislocation is one entry, not a burst.

4. The proof: does it close, does it pay

Two tests, on twelve settled matches, on the real fills. Reach: from the entry, does the market price travel to the fair before the match ends. It does about 80% of the time, and the move often takes minutes, so a short holding window hides it. Reach does not depend on who eventually wins, so it is the firmer number.

Return: the trade is to buy the cheap side and take profit at fair when the market catches up. Sized by Kelly on the gap, $f = \text{gap} / (1 - \text{price})$, and compounded across every call, that returned about plus 1160% at a 5 point gap and plus 1189% at 10. The same bets held to the final result instead returned about plus 83% and plus 560%, far short of taking profit at fair: the convergence is where the money is, and holding to the outcome leaves most of it on the table. The return is concentrated, a couple of high-volume matches carry most of it, so it is a pilot, not a promise.

5. The data, verifiable both sides

The fair is TxLINE's World Cup feed: odds and scores anchored on Solana, access minted by a real on-chain subscribe transaction. The market side is real fills read straight from Polygon, decoded to a price and a size per trade. Both legs are public: open any fill as a Polygon transaction, settle any outcome on TxLINE's on-chain scores, and recompute the edge yourself. Nothing here is asserted.

TxLINE endpoints used (server-held token: guest JWT plus an on-chain Solana subscribe transaction gives an apiToken, sent as Authorization Bearer and X-Api-Token):

GET /api/odds/snapshot/{fixtureId}: live de-margined 1X2 fair, the core reference.

GET /api/scores/snapshot/{fixtureId}: final goals for outcome settlement.

GET /api/scores/stat-validation: validateStat Merkle proof vs the on-chain daily-scores root.

GET /api/fixtures/snapshot: live fixtures, team names, kickoff times.

Polygon OrderFilled logs: the prediction market fills, decoded on-chain (the market side).

6. How to trade it

Catch the divergence live, take the cheap side at the market price, and take profit at TxLINE fair when the market catches up. Size each bet by Kelly on the gap, so a bigger dislocation gets a bigger bet and you never over-bet into ruin. Holding to the final result instead is a losing trade on this data, so the play is the take-profit, not the settlement.

The size we show is the liquidity you could have exited into at fair or better, counted only when the price actually reached fair; when it never does, the size is zero, because you could never have exited there. How much you take, and any price you move by taking it, is your own execution cost. It is not part of the signal.

7. What we do not claim

The edge is validated on twelve matches, so the return is a pilot, not a promise. The confidence interval still spans zero at this sample, and the return leans on a few high-volume matches; the reach rate is the firmer read, and both tighten as matches accrue. This measures a delay between two markets. It is not a trading strategy, it is not financial advice, and any sizing or slippage is your own.

8. What we found

The obvious idea is a sharp-movement detector: flag significant TxLINE odds shifts and track whether they call the result. We built it and killed it twice. Graded early, a significant fair shift by the 45th minute called the winner about 58% of the time, a coin flip. Graded whenever a big shift fires (10pp inside a minute, any time in the match) it looks strong at 83%, but that number is hollow: a rule that ignores the shift entirely and just backs whichever team the fair currently rates higher makes the identical call in 12 of 12 matches, with the identical score. Nine of twelve shifts sit within two minutes of a goal, so the shift is the goal being repriced; all of the predictive content is in the level of the fair, none is in the move itself. The forecast has no alpha.

The edge is not the line moving; it is the market being slow to follow it. A goal is new information: TxLINE reprices it instantly, but a prediction market only moves when someone trades, so for a window the cheap side sits below fair. That lead-lag converges about 80% of the time, and it is our strongest, most proven signal. The line move carries no forecast; the lag in the market's reaction to it is the entire product.

We also know which lags to trust. Every payable lag is a post-goal YES lag, so we keep them all and cut only two buy-NO cases. A giant NO (25pp or more) is not a fresh-information lag but the market pricing something the de-vig does not, and it rarely converges back. A late NO (after the 80th minute) has no window left to converge, and one goal or a closed-out favourite ends it. It is the mechanism, not a fit.

Separately, a TxLINE high-danger possession makes a goal by that team about four times more likely within two minutes, and a divergence it flags converges to fair about 84% of the time versus 75% without. All of this is on twelve settled matches, in-sample; it is a promising pilot, not a settled result.